

On 23 October 1962 President Kennedy signs the proclamation authorising the imposition of ‘a strict naval quarantine of all offensive military equipment’ to Cuba. The quarantine came into effect at 10am Eastern Daylight Time on Wednesday, 24 October 1962. *(Public Domain)*



The only ship to be stopped and searched during the blockade was the Sovietchartered, Lebanese-registered freighter, the Marucla. Here it is seen on 26